

VOCABULARY · CULTURE · ACTIVITIES

FRIDA KAHLO

La pintora de la Casa Azul

The life, the colours and the animals of Mexico's most famous painter, with Spain 🇪🇸 and Argentina 🇦🇷 vocabulary

PONCHO
SPANISH

¡HOLA!

Frida Kahlo painted herself more than anybody else has ever painted themselves. She put her face, her flowers, her monkeys, her pain and her country on small canvases, and a hundred years later the whole world recognises them.

This resource collects more than 80 words and expressions around her life and her art, each one with a real example sentence: who she was, the blue house where she was born and died, her self-portraits, her colours and flowers, her animals and what she left behind.

You don't need to know anything about art to start. The words here are everyday Spanish: colours, animals, family, feelings. At the end you'll find activities to check what you remember, and all the answers.

How to use it

1. **Read the word, then the sentence.** Words stick better when you see them in action.
2. **Look up one painting as you go.** Try «Las dos Fridas» or «Viva la vida».
3. **Say the colours out loud.** Half of Frida's Spanish is colour.
4. **Try the activities** without looking back, then check the answers.

La pintora

A woman who paints is **la pintora**; a man is **el pintor**. Lots of jobs work like this in Spanish, and Frida used the feminine with pride.

el pintor = **la pintora**

Two countries, two words

Frida was Mexican, so her world is Mexican. The everyday words around her do change from country to country: when you see two options, the first is common in Spain 🇪🇸 and the second in Argentina 🇦🇷.

la falda 🇪🇸 = **la pollera** 🇦🇷

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01

¿QUIÉN FUE FRIDA?

WHO SHE WAS

A life in one page: Coyoacán, an accident, a brush and a mirror.

ESPAÑOL	ENGLISH	EN UNA FRASE
la pintora	the painter (woman)	*Frida Kahlo fue una pintora mexicana.* Frida Kahlo was a Mexican painter.
nacer	to be born	*Nació en Coyoacán en 1907.* She was born in Coyoacán in 1907.
mexicano / mexicana	Mexican	*Se sentía profundamente mexicana.* She felt deeply Mexican.
la niñez	childhood	*Tuvo polio en la niñez.* She had polio as a child.
el accidente	the accident	*A los dieciocho años tuvo un accidente.* At eighteen she had an accident.
el autobús 🇪🇸 el colectivo 🇦🇷	the bus	*El autobús chocó contra un tranvía.* The bus crashed into a tram.
el dolor	the pain	*Vivió con dolor toda su vida.* She lived with pain all her life.
la cama	the bed	*Empezó a pintar en la cama.* She started painting in bed.
el espejo	the mirror	*Pusieron un espejo encima de su cama.* They put a mirror above her bed.
pintar	to paint	*Pintaba lo que veía en el espejo.* She painted what she saw in the mirror.
la fuerza	strength	*Tenía una fuerza enorme.* She had enormous strength.

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01 · ¿QUIÉN FUE FRIDA? WHO SHE WAS

ESPAÑOL	ENGLISH	EN UNA FRASE
casarse	to get married	*Se casó con el pintor Diego Rivera.* She married the painter Diego Rivera.
el marido	the husband	*Su marido pintaba murales gigantes.* Her husband painted giant murals.
morir	to die	*Murió en 1954, a los cuarenta y siete años.* She died in 1954, aged forty-seven.

¿SABÍAS QUE...?

Frida was born on 6 July 1907, but she often told people she was born in 1910, the year the Mexican Revolution began. She wanted her life and the new Mexico to start on the same day.

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02

LA CASA AZUL

THE BLUE HOUSE

The house where she was born, where she painted and where she died.

ESPAÑOL	ENGLISH	EN UNA FRASE
la casa	the house	*La casa es de un azul muy fuerte.* The house is a very strong blue.
azul	blue	*Por eso se llama la Casa Azul.* That's why it's called the Blue House.
el jardín	the garden	*En el jardín hay plantas y pirámides pequeñas.* In the garden there are plants and small pyramids.
el patio	the courtyard	*El patio está lleno de macetas.* The courtyard is full of plant pots.
la cocina	the kitchen	*La cocina tiene azulejos amarillos.* The kitchen has yellow tiles.
el taller	the studio, the workshop	*Su taller está igual que entonces.* Her studio is just as it was.
el caballete	the easel	*El caballete sigue junto a la ventana.* The easel is still beside the window.
el pincel	the paintbrush	*Los pinceles están en un vaso.* The brushes are in a glass.
la ventana	the window	*Desde la ventana se ve el jardín.* You can see the garden from the window.
la silla de ruedas	the wheelchair	*Pintaba sentada en su silla de ruedas.* She painted sitting in her wheelchair.
el museo	the museum	*Hoy la casa es un museo.* Today the house is a museum.

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02 · LA CASA AZUL THE BLUE HOUSE

ESPAÑOL	ENGLISH	EN UNA FRASE
visitar	to visit	*Miles de personas la visitan cada año.* Thousands of people visit it every year.
el piso 🇪🇸 el departamento 🇦🇷	the flat	*Antes vivían en un piso del centro.* Before, they lived in a flat in the centre.
vivir	to live	*Vivió allí casi toda su vida.* She lived there for almost all her life.

¿SABÍAS QUE...?

La Casa Azul, in the Coyoacán neighbourhood of Mexico City, is the house where Frida was born and where she died. It opened as the Museo Frida Kahlo in 1958, and her clothes, her brushes and her wheelchair are still inside.

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03

LOS AUTORRETRATOS

THE SELF-PORTRAITS

More than fifty paintings of the same face, and never the same picture twice.

ESPAÑOL	ENGLISH	EN UNA FRASE
el cuadro	the painting	*Pintó más de cien cuadros.* She painted more than a hundred pictures.
el autorretrato	the self-portrait	*Un autorretrato es un cuadro de uno mismo.* A self-portrait is a painting of yourself.
la cara	the face	*Su cara es la más pintada de México.* Hers is the most painted face in Mexico.
la ceja	the eyebrow	*Nunca escondió sus cejas.* She never hid her eyebrows.
la mirada	the gaze, the look	*Su mirada va directa a los ojos.* Her gaze goes straight to your eyes.
serio / seria	serious	*Casi nunca sonríe en sus cuadros.* She almost never smiles in her paintings.
el fondo	the background	*En el fondo hay hojas enormes.* In the background there are huge leaves.
el collar	the necklace	*Lleva un collar de espinas.* She wears a necklace of thorns.
el símbolo	the symbol	*Cada objeto es un símbolo.* Every object is a symbol.
el sueño	the dream	*Decía que pintaba su realidad, no sueños.* She said she painted her reality, not dreams.
sentir	to feel	*Pintaba lo que sentía.* She painted what she felt.

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03 · LOS AUTORRETRATOS THE SELF-PORTRAITS

ESPAÑOL	ENGLISH	EN UNA FRASE
la pintura	the paint, painting	*La pintura fue su manera de hablar.* Painting was how she spoke.
las gafas 🇪🇸 los anteojos 🇦🇷	the glasses	*Diego aparece con gafas en un cuadro.* Diego appears wearing glasses in one painting.
mirar	to look at	*Miras el cuadro y el cuadro te mira.* You look at the painting and the painting looks back.

¿SABÍAS QUE...?

About a third of everything Frida painted is a self-portrait. She explained it simply: she was alone a great deal, and she was the subject she knew best.

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04

LOS COLORES Y LAS FLORES

COLOURS AND FLOWERS

Her clothes, her hair and her canvases, all at full volume.

ESPAÑOL	ENGLISH	EN UNA FRASE
el color	the colour	*Sus colores son de mercado mexicano.* Her colours come from a Mexican market.
rojo	red	*El rojo aparece en casi todos sus cuadros.* Red appears in almost all her paintings.
verde	green	*El verde de las hojas es muy oscuro.* The green of the leaves is very dark.
amarillo	yellow	*El amarillo era su color de la locura y el sol.* Yellow was her colour of madness and sun.
morado	purple	*Lleva una cinta morada en el pelo.* She wears a purple ribbon in her hair.
la flor	the flower	*Siempre lleva flores en la cabeza.* She always wears flowers in her hair.
la corona de flores	the flower crown	*La corona de flores es su marca.* The flower crown is her trademark.
la trenza	the plait	*Se recogía el pelo en trenzas.* She tied her hair up in plaits.
el vestido	the dress	*Sus vestidos venían de Tehuantepec.* Her dresses came from Tehuantepec.
la falda 🇪🇸 la pollera 🇦🇷	the skirt	*La falda es larga y de colores.* The skirt is long and colourful.
el rebozo	the shawl	*El rebozo le cubre los hombros.* The shawl covers her shoulders.

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04 · LOS COLORES Y LAS FLORES COLOURS AND FLOWERS

ESPAÑOL	ENGLISH	EN UNA FRASE
la sandía	the watermelon	*Pintó sandías en su último cuadro.* She painted watermelons in her last picture.
la fresa 🇪🇸 la frutilla 🇦🇷	the strawberry	*En la mesa hay fresas y flores.* On the table there are strawberries and flowers.
bonito 🇪🇸 lindo 🇦🇷	beautiful	*¡Qué bonito es ese cuadro!* What a beautiful painting that is!

¿SABÍAS QUE...?

Frida's long skirts and shawls come from the Tehuana women of Tehuantepec, in Oaxaca, a region known for women who run the markets and the money. She chose those clothes on purpose: they were a way of saying where she stood.

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05

LOS ANIMALES DE FRIDA

FRIDA'S ANIMALS

The Blue House was half house, half small zoo.

ESPAÑOL	ENGLISH	EN UNA FRASE
el animal	the animal	*Tuvo muchísimos animales en casa.* She had an enormous number of animals at home.
la mascota	the pet	*Sus mascotas salen en sus cuadros.* Her pets appear in her paintings.
el mono	the monkey	*Tenía monos araña en el jardín.* She had spider monkeys in the garden.
el perro	the dog	*Sus perros eran xoloitzcuintles mexicanos.* Her dogs were Mexican xoloitzcuintles.
el loro	the parrot	*Los loros comían en la mesa.* The parrots ate at the table.
el pájaro	the bird	*Un pájaro pequeño cuelga de su collar.* A small bird hangs from her necklace.
el ciervo	the deer	*Tuvo un ciervo que se llamaba Granizo.* She had a deer called Granizo.
el gato	the cat	*Detrás del mono hay un gato negro.* Behind the monkey there's a black cat.
el águila	the eagle	*El águila está en la bandera de México.* The eagle is on the Mexican flag.
la mariposa	the butterfly	*Las mariposas aparecen sobre su cabeza.* Butterflies appear above her head.
la hoja	the leaf	*Las hojas llenan el fondo del cuadro.* Leaves fill the background of the painting.

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05 · LOS ANIMALES DE FRIDA FRIDA'S ANIMALS

ESPAÑOL	ENGLISH	EN UNA FRASE
cuidar	to look after	*Cuidaba a sus animales como a su familia.* She looked after her animals like family.
acompañar	to keep company	*Los animales la acompañaban al pintar.* The animals kept her company while she painted.
querer	to love	*Quería a sus monos muchísimo.* She loved her monkeys enormously.

¿SABÍAS QUE...?

The xoloitzcuintle, Frida's favourite breed of dog, is one of the oldest in the world and has almost no hair. Its name comes from Nahuatl, the language of the Aztecs, and Mexicans usually shorten it to xolo.

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06

SU LEGADO

WHAT SHE LEFT BEHIND

From a small blue house to the whole world.

ESPAÑOL	ENGLISH	EN UNA FRASE
el legado	the legacy	*Su legado crece cada año.* Her legacy grows every year.
famoso / famosa	famous	*Hoy es más famosa que en vida.* Today she is more famous than she was in life.
la exposición	the exhibition	*Su primera exposición en México fue en 1953.* Her first exhibition in Mexico was in 1953.
el arte	art	*Su arte habla de dolor y de alegría.* Her art speaks of pain and of joy.
la mujer	the woman	*Muchas mujeres la ven como un ejemplo.* Many women see her as an example.
la libertad	freedom	*Pintó su propia libertad.* She painted her own freedom.
la valentía	courage	*Su valentía sorprende todavía.* Her courage still surprises people.
el billete	the banknote	*Está en el billete de quinientos pesos.* She is on the five-hundred-peso note.
la camiseta	the T-shirt	*Su cara está hasta en camisetas.* Her face is even on T-shirts.
la película	the film	*Hay una película sobre su vida.* There's a film about her life.
inspirar	to inspire	*Inspira a artistas de todo el mundo.* She inspires artists all over the world.

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06 · SU LEGADO

WHAT SHE LEFT BEHIND

ESPAÑOL	ENGLISH	EN UNA FRASE
recordar	to remember	*México la recuerda cada julio.* Mexico remembers her every July.
¡Viva la vida!	Long live life!	*Escribió «Viva la vida» en su último cuadro.* She wrote 'Viva la vida' on her last painting.
enfadarse 🇪🇸 enojarse 🇦🇷	to get angry	*Se enfadaba con quien no la tomaba en serio.* She got angry with anyone who didn't take her seriously.

¿SABÍAS QUE...?

Her very last painting is a plate of watermelons with ¡VIVA LA VIDA! written into the red flesh of one slice. She finished it days before she died, in 1954.

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07

FRASES PARA HABLAR DE ARTE

PHRASES FOR TALKING ABOUT ART

Short sentences you could really say in front of a painting. When there are two versions, the second is how you'd say it in Argentina.

¿Quién pintó este cuadro?
Who painted this picture?

Lo pintó Frida Kahlo.
Frida Kahlo painted it.

Es un autorretrato.
It's a self-portrait.

¿De qué año es?
What year is it from?

Me gusta mucho este color.
I really like this colour.

¿Qué ves en el fondo?
What can you see in the background?

Hay flores y un mono.
There are flowers and a monkey.

¿Qué crees que siente?
What do you think she's feeling?

Creo que está triste.
I think she's sad.

¡Qué bonito! / ¡Qué lindo!
How beautiful!

Yo quiero pintar así.
I want to paint like that.

¡Viva la vida!
Long live life!

¿SABÍAS QUE...?

Frida appears on the Mexican 500-peso note together with Diego Rivera, one on each side. She is one of very few artists in the world whose face is on their country's money.

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08

¡A PRACTICAR!

ACTIVITIES

1 MATCH THEM UP

Write the letter of the English meaning next to each Spanish word or phrase.

1	la pintora	☐	A	the painting
2	el cuadro	☐	B	the monkey
3	el autorretrato	☐	C	the Blue House
4	el pincel	☐	D	the painter (woman)
5	la flor	☐	E	the museum
6	el mono	☐	F	the flower
7	la Casa Azul	☐	G	the mirror
8	el espejo	☐	H	the self-portrait
9	la sandía	☐	I	the watermelon
10	el museo	☐	J	the paintbrush

2 ¿VERDADERO O FALSO?

Read each sentence and circle V (true) or F (false).

1. Frida Kahlo nació en México. **V** **F**
2. Frida Kahlo pintaba sobre todo paisajes del mar. **V** **F**
3. La Casa Azul está en Coyoacán y hoy es un museo. **V** **F**
4. Frida se casó con el pintor Diego Rivera. **V** **F**
5. Frida tenía monos, perros y loros en casa. **V** **F**
6. Frida escribió «Viva la vida» en su primer cuadro. **V** **F**

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3 UNA VISITA A LA CASA AZUL

Complete the text with the words from the box.

azul | museo | jardín | taller | pinceles | cuadros | flores | vida

Hoy visité la Casa _____ de Coyoacán, que hoy es un _____. Entras por el _____, lleno de plantas verdes. Arriba está su _____, con el caballete junto a la ventana y los _____ todavía en un vaso. En las paredes hay _____ pequeños, con muchas _____ de colores. Al salir pensé en su última frase: ¡Viva la _____!

4 SPAIN OR ARGENTINA?

Write the word used in Argentina next to the one used in Spain.

- **el autobús** → _____
- **el piso** → _____
- **la falda** → _____
- **enfadarse** → _____
- **las gafas** → _____
- **bonito** → _____
- **la fresa** → _____
- **coger** → _____

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5 SOPA DE LETRAS

Find the 12 words. They go across → or down ↓.

C	B	J	U	P	J	N	M	A	P	M	F
C	V	D	R	B	G	J	E	H	N	N	R
U	F	C	P	I	N	T	O	R	A	F	P
A	L	N	S	A	N	D	I	A	T	I	E
D	O	O	T	I	O	M	F	R	I	D	A
R	R	N	H	E	C	F	E	H	H	P	A
O	E	R	U	F	I	J	A	E	O	I	T
M	S	M	E	X	I	C	O	V	M	N	A
U	L	E	E	S	P	E	J	O	O	C	Z
C	O	L	O	R	E	S	S	V	N	E	U
B	M	U	S	E	O	P	T	N	O	L	L
N	N	N	D	R	N	B	G	C	G	P	F

FRIDA
PINTORA
CUADRO
ESPEJO
PINCEL
FLORES
MONO
AZUL
MUSEO
SANDIA
COLORES
MEXICO

6 PUT IT IN ORDER

Unscramble each sentence and write it on the line.

1. **fue / Frida / Kahlo / mexicana / pintora / una**

_____

2. **color / Me / mucho / este / gusta**

_____

3. **autorretrato / un / Es**

_____

4. **un / es / museo / Hoy / la / casa**

_____

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7 TU AUTORRETRATO

Imagine you are painting a self-portrait like Frida's. Write four or five sentences: what you are wearing, what colours you use, what is in the background and which animal is next to you, and why. Use at least six words from this resource.

Try: En mi autorretrato llevo... Los colores son... En el fondo hay... A mi lado está mi...

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ANSWERS

1 · MATCH THEM UP

1–D, 2–A, 3–H, 4–J, 5–F, 6–B, 7–C, 8–G, 9–I, 10–E

2 · ¿VERDADERO O FALSO?

1 V, 2 F, 3 V, 4 V, 5 V, 6 F

3 · UNA VISITA A LA CASA AZUL

1. azul, 2. museo, 3. jardín, 4. taller, 5. pinceles, 6. cuadros, 7. flores, 8. vida

4 · SPAIN OR ARGENTINA?

el autobús → el colectivo; la falda → la pollera; las gafas → los anteojos; la fresa → la frutilla; el piso → el departamento; enfadarse → enojarse; bonito → lindo; coger → agarrar

6 · PUT IT IN ORDER

Frida Kahlo fue una pintora mexicana. · Me gusta mucho este color. · Es un autorretrato. · Hoy la casa es un museo.

7 · TU AUTORRETRATO

Any answer that uses six words from this resource is perfect. If you feel like it, draw it afterwards: Frida started exactly like that, with a mirror and some time on her hands.

5 · SOPA DE LETRAS

C	B	J	U	P	J	N	M	A	P	M	F
C	V	D	R	B	G	J	E	H	N	N	R
U	F	C	P	I	N	T	O	R	A	F	P
A	L	N	S	A	N	D	I	A	T	I	E
D	O	O	T	I	O	M	F	R	I	D	A
R	R	N	H	E	C	F	E	H	H	P	A
O	E	R	U	F	I	J	A	E	O	I	T
M	S	M	E	X	I	C	O	V	M	N	A
U	L	E	E	S	P	E	J	O	O	C	Z
C	O	L	O	R	E	S	S	V	N	E	U
B	M	U	S	E	O	P	T	N	O	L	L
N	N	N	D	R	N	B	G	C	G	P	F

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¡VIVA LA VIDA!

SEE YOU SOON

Frida turned a bed, a mirror and a box of paints into a whole world. You already have the words for her colours, her flowers and her animals: now go and look at one of her paintings properly.

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